CLASS BOOK - EPIC CAMPUS GENERAL ENGLISH

The 12 tenses

Class book: explanation and practice, one tense at a time

How to use this book

1. Teach **one tense a day**. Give the student tute for that tense.
2. Fill in the table **together**: say the formula, write the first example, then ask the students for more.
3. Students write their own examples on the blank lines.
4. Do the tute activity: A on the board together, B alone, C by discussion.
5. Correct the tense kindly and straight away.

The order

Present	Past	Future
1. Present simple	5. Past simple	9. Future simple
2. Present continuous	6. Past continuous	10. Future continuous
3. Present perfect	7. Past perfect	11. Future perfect
4. Present perfect continuous	8. Past perfect continuous	12. Future perfect continuous

> Pages 14 to 16: practice for each group. Page 17: summary for all 12 tenses. Page 18: chart of every formula. Page 19: teacher notes.

1. Present simple

Tense 1 of 12

In simple words: Use it for **things we do again and again** and for **facts**. After he, she, it add **-s**. For not, use **do not / does not** and the base verb.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

every day, always, usually, often, never, on Mondays

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + V1 (add -s / -es after he, she, it)** **She studies English every day.**	
Negative	**S + do not / does not + V1** **She does not study Korean on Sunday.**	
Active	**S + V1 + object** **The teacher checks the papers.**	
Passive	**am / is / are + V3** **The papers are checked by the teacher.**	

2. Present continuous

Tense 2 of 12

In simple words: Use it for **things happening now**. Build it with **am / is / are + verb-ing**. Look for **now** and **at the moment**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

now, right now, at the moment, today, Look!, Listen!

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + am / is / are + V-ing** **She is reading a book.**	
Negative	**S + am / is / are + not + V-ing** **She is not reading a book.**	
Active	**S + am / is / are + V-ing + object** **The teacher is checking the papers.**	
Passive	**am / is / are + being + V3** **The papers are being checked.**	

3. Present perfect

Tense 3 of 12

In simple words: Use it for something that happened before now when the **result still matters**. Build it with **have / has + V3**. Look for **already**, **yet**, **ever**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

already, yet, just, ever, never, since, for, so far

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + have / has + V3** **She has finished her homework.**	
Negative	**S + have / has + not + V3** **She has not finished her homework.**	
Active	**S + have / has + V3 + object** **The teacher has checked the papers.**	
Passive	**have / has + been + V3** **The papers have been checked.**	

4. Present perfect continuous

Tense 4 of 12

In simple words: Use it for something that **started in the past and is still going on**. Build it with **have / has been + verb-ing**. It tells us **how long**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

for, since, all day, how long, lately, recently

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + have / has + been + V-ing** **She has been studying for two hours.**	
Negative	**S + have / has + not + been + V-ing** **She has not been studying.**	
Active	**S + have / has + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher has been checking papers all day.**	
Passive	**Rarely used.** **Use instead: The papers have been checked.**	

5. Past simple

Tense 5 of 12

In simple words: Use it for an action that is **finished in the past**. Add **-ed** or use **V2**. For not, use **did not** and the base verb.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

yesterday, last week, ago, in 2020, when I was young

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + V2 (regular: +ed)** **She studied last night.**	
Negative	**S + did not + V1** **She did not study last night.**	
Active	**S + V2 + object** **The teacher checked the papers.**	
Passive	**was / were + V3** **The papers were checked by the teacher.**	

6. Past continuous

Tense 6 of 12

In simple words: Use it for an action that **was happening at a moment in the past**. Build it with **was / were + verb-ing**. Often used with **while** and **when**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

while, when, at 8 o'clock yesterday, all evening

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + was / were + V-ing** **She was studying at eight.**	
Negative	**S + was / were + not + V-ing** **She was not studying at eight.**	
Active	**S + was / were + V-ing + object** **The teacher was checking the papers.**	
Passive	**was / were + being + V3** **The papers were being checked.**	

7. Past perfect

Tense 7 of 12

In simple words: Use it for the **earlier of two past actions**. Build it with **had + V3**. Look for **before** and **by the time**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

before, after, already, by the time, when

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + had + V3** **She had left before I arrived.**	
Negative	**S + had not + V3** **She had not left before I arrived.**	
Active	**S + had + V3 + object** **The teacher had checked the papers.**	
Passive	**had + been + V3** **The papers had been checked.**	

8. Past perfect continuous

Tense 8 of 12

In simple words: Use it for an action that **went on for some time before** another past moment. Build it with **had been + verb-ing**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

for, since, how long, before, when

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + had + been + V-ing** **She had been studying for two hours.**	
Negative	**S + had not + been + V-ing** **She had not been studying.**	
Active	**S + had + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher had been checking papers for hours.**	
Passive	**Rarely used.** **Use instead: The papers had been checked.**	

9. Future simple

Tense 9 of 12

In simple words: Use it for **decisions, predictions and promises**. Build it with **will + base verb**. It is the same for every subject.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

tomorrow, next week, soon, I think, probably

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + will + V1** **She will call you tomorrow.**	
Negative	**S + will not (won't) + V1** **She will not call you tomorrow.**	
Active	**S + will + V1 + object** **The teacher will check the papers.**	
Passive	**will + be + V3** **The papers will be checked.**	

10. Future continuous

Tense 10 of 12

In simple words: Use it for an action that **will be happening at a moment in the future**. Build it with **will be + verb-ing**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

this time tomorrow, at 8 o'clock tonight, next week

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + will + be + V-ing** **She will be studying at eight.**	
Negative	**S + will not + be + V-ing** **She will not be studying at eight.**	
Active	**S + will + be + V-ing + object** **The teacher will be checking the papers.**	
Passive	**Rarely used.** **Use instead: The papers will be checked.**	

11. Future perfect

Tense 11 of 12

In simple words: Use it for an action that will be **finished before a future moment**. Build it with **will have + V3**. Look for **by**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

by, by the time, by next year, before

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + will + have + V3** **She will have finished by June.**	
Negative	**S + will not + have + V3** **She will not have finished by June.**	
Active	**S + will + have + V3 + object** **The teacher will have checked the papers.**	
Passive	**will + have + been + V3** **The papers will have been checked.**	

12. Future perfect continuous

Tense 12 of 12

In simple words: Use it to say **how long** an action will have been going on up to a future moment. Build it with **will have been + verb-ing**.

WORDS THAT GO WITH IT

by, for, by next month, by the time

	Formula and one example	Write your own examples
Affirmative	**S + will + have + been + V-ing** **She will have been studying for six hours.**	
Negative	**S + will not + have + been + V-ing** **She will not have been studying for long.**	
Active	**S + will + have + been + V-ing + object** **The teacher will have been checking papers for six hours.**	
Passive	**Rarely used.** **Use instead: The papers will have been checked.**	

CLASS BOOK - STUDENT PRACTICE

Practice: present tenses

Do the first one together. Then try the rest.

1. Present simple

1. My brother **plays** (play) cricket every Sunday.
2. We _____ (not eat) meat.
3. She _____ (go) to class by bus.

Talk: Tell your partner about your morning routine.

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2. Present continuous

1. Look! It **is raining** (rain).
2. I _____ (not watch) TV now.
3. They _____ (play) football at the moment.

Talk: What are you doing right now?

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3. Present perfect

1. I **have finished** (finish) my homework.
2. She _____ (not see) that film.
3. We _____ (live) here since 2020.

Talk: What have you done today?

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4. Present perfect continuous

1. I **have been waiting** (wait) for an hour.
2. She _____ (not sleep) well lately.
3. They _____ (study) since morning.

Talk: How long have you been studying English?

CLASS BOOK - STUDENT PRACTICE

Practice: past tenses

Do the first one together. Then try the rest.

5. Past simple

1. I **visited** (visit) Kandy last year.
2. She _____ (not go) to class yesterday.
3. We _____ (buy) tea.

Talk: What did you do yesterday?

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6. Past continuous

1. I **was sleeping** (sleep) when you called.
2. They _____ (not listen) to the teacher.
3. While she _____ (cook), the phone rang.

Talk: What were you doing at 8 o'clock last night?

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7. Past perfect

1. She **had left** (leave) before I arrived.
2. I _____ (not eat), so I was hungry.
3. They _____ (finish) when we got there.

Talk: What had you done before you came to class today?

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8. Past perfect continuous

1. I **had been waiting** (wait) for an hour when the bus came.
2. She _____ (not sleep) well, so she was tired.
3. They _____ (play) for two hours before it rained.

Talk: What had you been doing before class started?

CLASS BOOK - STUDENT PRACTICE

Practice: future tenses

Do the first one together. Then try the rest.

9. Future simple

1. I **will call** (call) you tomorrow.
2. She _____ (not come) to the party.
3. It _____ (rain) tonight, I think.

Talk: What will you do tomorrow?

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10. Future continuous

1. This time tomorrow I **will be flying** (fly) to Seoul.
2. She _____ (not work) at nine.
3. At 8 tonight we _____ (study).

Talk: What will you be doing this time tomorrow?

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11. Future perfect

1. By June I **will have finished** (finish) the course.
2. She _____ (not leave) by then.
3. By 2030 they _____ (build) a new road.

Talk: What will you have learned by the end of this course?

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12. Future perfect continuous

1. By June I **will have been studying** (study) Korean for six months.
2. She _____ (not work) for long.
3. By five o'clock they _____ (wait) for two hours.

Talk: By next year, how long will you have been learning English?

CLASS BOOK - SUMMARY

All 12 tenses: summary

Mixed practice: affirmative, negative, active and passive

Step 1. Name the tense (do together)

> Example 1: **The letter was written by Nimal.** Past simple, passive.
> Example 2: **They have not finished.** Present perfect, negative.

STUDENTS WRITE MORE SENTENCES AND NAME THEM

Step 2. Change the sentence (do together)

> Example: **The cook has made the food.** to the passive: The food has been made by the cook.

STUDENTS TRY THEIR OWN

Step 3. Practical task (group)

> Each student tells the group what they did yesterday, what they are doing now and what they will do tomorrow. The group names each tense.

CLASS BOOK - QUICK REFERENCE

Chart: all 12 tenses

Formulas for the teacher and for the board

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect continuous
Present	V1 (+s / es)	am / is / are + V-ing	have / has + V3	have / has been + V-ing
Past	V2	was / were + V-ing	had + V3	had been + V-ing
Future	will + V1	will be + V-ing	will have + V3	will have been + V-ing

Passive voice

Tense	Passive formula
Present simple	am / is / are + V3
Present continuous	am / is / are + being + V3
Present perfect	have / has + been + V3
Past simple	was / were + V3
Past continuous	was / were + being + V3
Past perfect	had + been + V3
Future simple	will + be + V3
Future perfect	will + have + been + V3

> The four perfect continuous and future continuous passives are almost never used. Use the simple passive instead.

CLASS BOOK - TEACHER NOTES

Teacher notes

One short tip for each tense

Tense	Tip
1. Present simple	Stress the -s after he, she, it. Common mistakes: "he go", "she don't like". Do/does is only for the negative and the question; the verb goes back to V1.
2. Present continuous	Do the spelling of -ing: write → writing, run → running, make → making. Do not use it with state verbs (know, like, want): "I know", not "I am knowing".
3. Present perfect	Use V3 (the list from the verb forms tute). Do not use it with a finished time word: "I have seen him yesterday" is wrong; say "I saw him yesterday".
4. Present perfect continuous	The passive of this tense is almost never used. Tell students to use the present perfect passive instead (The papers have been checked). Compare with present perfect: "I have read the book" (finished) and "I have been reading" (still going or just stopped).
5. Past simple	After "did" the verb is V1: "did not go", not "did not went". Revise the V2 column of the verb forms list.
6. Past continuous	Draw a time line: the long action is a wavy line, the short action cuts across it. "While" goes with the long action, "when" with the short one.
7. Past perfect	Draw two events on a line: the earlier one is past perfect, the later one is past simple. "Had" is the same for every subject.
8. Past perfect continuous	The passive is almost never used. Use the past perfect passive instead (The papers had been checked). Compare: "had waited" (finished) and "had been waiting" (stresses how long).
9. Future simple	"Will" is the same for every subject and is followed by V1 (never "will goes"). "Going to" is the plan form; keep it for later.
10. Future continuous	The passive is very rare and sounds heavy ("will be being checked"). Use the future simple passive instead (The papers will be checked).
11. Future perfect	The key word is "by". Draw the future deadline on a line and mark the action finished before it.
12. Future perfect continuous	This is the rarest tense. Teach it last, keep it short, and do not use a passive (use the future perfect passive: The papers will have been checked).